

Title: YOGA AND MENTAL RESILIENCE IN ARMED FORCES

National Cadet Corps (NCC) â Official Directorate General Training Notes

1. **ROLE OF YOGA IN MILITARY TRAINING:** Classical Indian Yogic science combines physical postures (Asanas), controlled breathing (Pranayama), and focused meditation (Dhyana) to develop exceptional mental toughness, emotional equilibrium, and neuromuscular stamina under battlefield stress.

2. **KEY ASANAS FOR CADET CONDITIONING:** Surya Namaskar (12-step sequence) builds full-body flexibility and core stability. Tadasana and Vrikshasana improve posture and equilibrium on balance beams. Bhujangasana and Dhanurasana strengthen the spinal column against back strain caused by heavy pack carrying.

3. **PRANAYAMA & STRESS MITIGATION:** Controlled breathing techniques such as Anulom Vilom, Kapalbhata, and Bhramari reduce resting heart rate, lower cortisol stress markers, enhance lung capacity for high-altitude deployment, and restore focus during precision firing competitions.